

Rhomaleosaurus

In 1848, miners in a quarry in Yorkshire, England, were astonished when they discovered the skeleton of a huge creature buried in the rock. It was *Rhomaleosaurus*, one of the most fearsome predators of the Jurassic seas. At the time, the seas were ruled by two kinds of marine reptile—the dolphinlike ichthyosaurs and lizardlike creatures with long necks known as plesiosaurs. *Rhomaleosaurus* belonged to the plesiosaur family.

